

ANGEL ACTION · TRAUMA

Head Injury and Concussion

Always suspect a spinal injury with a head injury. Lay the person down, control bleeding without direct pressure on a depressed area, and call 000 for any loss of consciousness, vomiting or confusion.

Concerning signs

- Loss of consciousness — even briefly
- Persistent headache, confusion, drowsiness
- Repeated vomiting
- Unequal pupils or vision changes
- Seizures
- Clear fluid or blood from the nose or ears
- Weakness or numbness in any limb

Any of these — **call 000**.

What to do

1. Follow **DRSABCD**.
2. Always suspect a **spinal injury**. Keep the head and neck still.
3. **Conscious**: lie them down with the head and shoulders slightly raised. Control any bleeding (avoid pressure on a depressed skull area).
4. **Unconscious but breathing**: place in the **recovery position**, supporting the head and neck.
5. Do not give anything to eat or drink.
6. Stay with them until paramedics arrive.

Concussion

Anyone who has had loss of consciousness or significant memory loss from a head blow should **not** return to sport, driving or work until cleared by a doctor. Watch for delayed deterioration over the next 24–48 hours.

*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.*